A-A-53144
21 August 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TUBE, BIOLOGICAL CULTURE SAMPLING (Plastic)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Military Specification MIL-T-37193.

This Commercial Item Description covers a disposable, sterile, double swab, plastic culture tube, without transport media, suitable for obtaining and maintaining uncontaminated cultures.

Salient Characteristics.

Shall be an assembled sterile culture tube, without transport media, suitable for obtaining and maintaining uncontaminated cultures.

Shall consist of a tube, closure cap, and two swabs that are attached to the inside of the closure cap. Shall be supplied sealed in a suitable envelope or bag which shall maintain the sterility of the culture tube until manually opened. The outside surfaces of the assembled culture tube within the envelope or bag shall also be in a sterile condition. The envelope or bag shall not be resealable after opening.

The tube shall be supplied in an empty condition and shall be fabricated of polystyrene, polyethylene or a polypropylene co-polymer. The overall length of the tube shall be at least 6 inches. The bottom end of the tube shall be closed.

The closure cap shall be fabricated of polyethylene. The design of the closure cap shall be such that, when it is positioned on the tube, it permits and maintains the sterilization of the contents within the tube and closure cap. The inside of the closure cap shall be designed to hold the two swab sticks firmly in place. The inside of the closure cap shall have two sockets or shall be molded to hold the two swabs firmly in place. If necessary, adhesives may be used to hold the swabs firmly in place. Closure caps that are designed to allow the swab sticks to be held in place by a friction fit and are detachable for optional use without the closure cap shall be acceptable. The overall length of closure cap with projecting swab sticks shall be at least 5-3/4 inches.

AMSC N/A FSC 6640

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The swabs shall consist of wood or plastic applicator sticks that are covered with swab tips at their distal ends. The swab tips shall be made of polyethylene terephthalate, rayon or cotton. A suitable adhesive shall be used to secure the swab tips to the sticks. Plastic applicator sticks, if supplied, shall have sufficient flexibility to preclude breaking when bent at the midpoint to an angle of at least eighty (80) degrees. The length of the swab sticks shall be such that when firmly positioned within the closure cap that is attached to the tube, results in the tipped ends clearing the bottom of the tube by at least 1/4 inch.

The method and efficacy of sterilization of the culture tube and inside surfaces of the bag or envelope shall be acceptable to the Food and Drug Administration (FDA).

Workmanship. The biological culture sampling tube shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one hundred individually packaged tubes, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Inspection and tests. Inspection and tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Sampling for inspection and tests. Sampling for inspection and tests shall be conducted in accordance with commercial practice.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/ contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promugated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/ suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

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Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6640-00-729-6484

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.)

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA - DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES
VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PROJECT NO. 6640-1423

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NOTE. This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER
A-A-53144

2 DOCUMENT TITLE
TUBE, BIOLOGICAL CULTURE SAMPLING

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

b ADDRESS (*Street City State ZIP Code*)

4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION (*Mark one*)

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER (*Specify*)

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER (*Last First MI*) – Optional

b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER (*Include Area Code*) – Optional

c MAILING ADDRESS (*Street City State ZIP Code*) – Optional

8 DATE OF SUBMISSION (*YYMMDD*)

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